

FreeCEN Newsletter – September 2026

Hello All

Welcome to the FreeCEN newsletter for September, and 36 new pieces have been added to the website over the last month, around 172,000 entries between these pieces. Details at the end of this newsletter.

These newsletters are sent on a monthly basis, and are usually sent out around the 4th of the month.

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Sources of Scans for Transcribing

Do you have access to any census images? If so then you may be able to help FreeCEN. We have people to transcribe the census but we are short of images for a good number of localities.

FreeCEN can accept loans or donations of scans, or is willing to buy scans (at reasonable prices), provided they originate from one of the following sources:

- Archive CD Books
- Stepping Stones CD's/DVD's (some restrictions apply)
- Family History Society CD's/DVD's (must come with written permission to use)
- Microfiche/Microfilms (must come with written permission to use)

Only scans from one of the four sources listed above can be accepted.

Can you help us with this? If so, do make contact with us and give us the details of what you have.

A reminder about transcription sources

We know that some of the images or scans available from approved sources can be difficult to read, so transcribers might understandably be tempted to use a clearer version from a paid subscription site such as Ancestry or Findmypast.

Please do not use these sites as a source for FreeCEN transcription. Their terms of use may restrict how records and images can be used, and using a personal subscription for FreeCEN transcription could breach those terms. This may put your account at risk, including possible suspension or termination by the provider.

Please only transcribe from sources that have been approved for FreeCEN use. If you are unsure whether a source is suitable, you can check with your coordinator before starting.

Contribution Guidelines

Contributions are welcome, and all received are considered. These should be emailed to [Chris Mahoney](mailto:chris.mahoney@freeukgenealogy.org.uk) (chris.mahoney@freeukgenealogy.org.uk).

They can be in any format, but I do have three particular requests with contributions.

1. Please do include a scanned image of the census record referred to (if appropriate) along with relevant source information (i.e. piece number, folio number, page number, and schedule number)
2. With any images, please include copies in their original format such as jpg or png (much easier to work with than copying one out of your article)
3. If you have quoted another source (or copied an image from somewhere), please quote what that source is

Previous FreeCEN Newsletters

Past editions of the newsletter are [now available to download](#) from the FreeCEN website. Or go to the “About” page, and then look on the right hand side under “See Also”.

The previous twelve are there now, all in downloadable PDF format (can also be read in some internet browsers). Older editions available on request.

Volunteer for FreeCEN

Like what you see in these newsletters? Has our website helped you with your family research? Then please consider helping to expand our database. We have plenty of coordinators who would welcome you as a member of their team.

You need only basic computer skills and you can use any spreadsheet app. We provide plenty of help and support. We also supply the scans.

Use this link to the [Volunteer page](#) or select “Volunteer” in the purple menu bar near the top of any page on the website.

News from Denise Colbert (Q2 April to June 2026)

(Chief Operating Officer, Free UK Genealogy CIO)

Hello everyone

In my last update, I wrote about the strong foundations we were putting in place across Free UK Genealogy. Much of that work was about preparing for the future: growing new projects, strengthening our volunteer community and turning ideas from the Strategy Weekend into practical action.

Three months on, it's been encouraging to see those foundations starting to bear fruit. We've reached some significant milestones, welcomed new volunteers into the organisation, and continued improving the projects that so many of you contribute to every day.

FreePRO has welcomed more volunteers, bringing expertise in areas including user experience, software development, testing and project support. Work on digitising the probate calendars has continued, alongside improvements to the tools and workflows that will support volunteers as the project grows.

FreeBMD2 has also continued to develop steadily. Since its launch, the team has been working through feedback from volunteers and users, making improvements to searching, accessibility and the ways people can report problems or suggest corrections. It's been particularly encouraging to see how much thoughtful feedback has come from our own volunteers, helping shape the site as it continues to mature.

The biggest single achievement this quarter comes from FreeCEN.

For several years, volunteers have been working to convert older FreeCEN1 VLD files into the newer CSV format used by FreeCEN2. It has been one of those long-running pieces of work that quietly underpins everything else, and I'm delighted to say that the final inter-county conversions have now been completed.

It's a wonderful example of what persistence can achieve. Hundreds of thousands of records have been brought into a stronger, more sustainable format, leaving FreeCEN in a much better position for future development.

The team has also continued improving searching, accessibility and support for a wider range of names and places, while thinking carefully about how we can make even more records available. One area we'll be encouraging volunteers to consider is proofreading. Many records have already been transcribed and are simply waiting for that final stage before they can be published, so proofreading is one of the most direct ways volunteers can help unlock new material for researchers. If helping us clear our proofreading backlog and make more records available to researchers sounds like something you'd enjoy, please speak to your Coordinator. They'd be delighted to tell you more.

FreeREG has also had a positive few months. FreeComETT-REG has its creator, Hilary, back on board helping the team regain momentum after a challenging period, and FreeREG has continued to make progress with a new cohort of software volunteers learning the ropes by clearing off some 'good first issues' from the backlog.

Across all of our projects, there have also been dozens of smaller improvements that may never make headlines but collectively make a real difference: refining search behaviour, improving accessibility, responding to user feedback, fixing bugs and making our websites easier to use. Those incremental improvements are every bit as important as the bigger milestones.

One of the most encouraging things this quarter has been seeing new volunteers join Free UK Genealogy.

Since my last update, Scott Paget has stepped down from his Programme Manager role. We're very grateful for the work Scott did to bring more structure to our newer projects. Stephen Coward has now taken on this role, and has already made a real difference, recruiting several volunteer Project Managers and helping us strengthen support across our projects.

We've welcomed volunteers into software development, communications, recruitment, project support and several other areas of the organisation.

Every new volunteer brings something different, and I'm very grateful to everyone who has given their time to help new arrivals settle in and feel part of the team.

So much recruitment has also prompted us to think more carefully about the volunteer journey. How do we make it easier for someone to find a role they'll enjoy? How do we support them as they learn? How do we help them grow if they decide they'd like to take on something new?

One conversation in the recent FreeCEN Coordinator meeting really stands out. Geoff was reflecting on Cheryl's journey to becoming a County Coordinator, and how that had happened gradually through encouragement and shared experience rather than by expecting someone to take on everything at once. I suspect many of us could tell a similar story. Free UK Genealogy has always been full of volunteers who are willing to help one another, and I hope that's something we'll continue to build on.

Over the next few days we'll be advertising for a new trustee, and this time we're particularly hoping to hear from people within our own volunteer community. Nobody understands our organisation better than the people who give their time to it every week, and we'd love to see more volunteers helping shape Free UK Genealogy at Board level.

The role will appear shortly on our Reach Volunteering page:
<https://reachvolunteering.org.uk/org/free-uk-genealogy>

We'll send the direct link around as soon as the advert is live. If you've ever wondered whether becoming a trustee might be for you, I do encourage you to have a look. Please don't rule yourself out because you haven't been a trustee before. Experience can be learned. Enthusiasm for our mission and sound judgement matter just as much.

The planned UK Genealogy Charity Summit took place in April at the Society of Genealogists HQ in London. Although every organisation around the table had its own priorities, it quickly became clear that many of us are wrestling with the same questions: how to recruit and support volunteers, improve access to records and ensure that family history remains freely available for future generations.

There was a genuine willingness to keep talking, share ideas and support one another. We've already started following up on some of those conversations, and I hope they'll lead to closer collaboration across the sector over the coming months.

As we move into the second half of the year, we'll continue improving our websites, supporting our projects and, most importantly, supporting the volunteers who make them possible.

One of the things that's become increasingly clear to me this year is that our greatest strength is the community of people behind them. Every improvement we make, every new record we publish and every new project we begin ultimately comes back to volunteers generously sharing their time and knowledge with others.

Thank you for everything you've contributed over the past three months. I look forward to updating you again in the autumn.

With best wishes,

Denise Colbert

Chief Operating Officer
Free UK Genealogy CIO

Volunteering Opportunities with FreeREG

Can you help FreeREG grow as a County Coordinator? We have several counties with images and transcribers and a caretaker coordinator following retirements. If you're familiar with transcribing, organised, supportive and confident with digital tools, this flexible home-based volunteer position is ideal for stepping into the role for the first time.

About the opportunity

FreeREG is part of Free UK Genealogy, a charity providing free online access to millions of family history records so people can discover and share their family and community stories. Our work depends on dedicated volunteers who transcribe and publish historic parish and register records for public benefit.

We are looking for committed volunteers from within the FreeREG/Free UK Genealogy community to take on the role of County Coordinator.

County Coordinators play an important part in helping FreeREG run smoothly. You will support transcribers working on records for your county, help manage the flow of images and data, and act as a key point of contact for both volunteers and researchers.

The role includes:

- Supporting transcribers who have completed training and helping them with questions or issues
- Working with archives and photographers to obtain register images
- Uploading and organising images on the FreeREG Image Server where permitted
- Recruiting and supporting volunteer transcribers as needed
- Assigning transcription work and reviewing submissions to help maintain high standards
- Responding to enquiries and correction requests from researchers and volunteers
- Making updates or corrections to records where necessary

The role is remote (from anywhere in the world) and flexible, with an estimated commitment starting from 4 to 6 hours per week. Most communication takes place online through email and occasional Google Meet video calls.

At present we have a number of counties where the coordinator has retired and the county is being temporarily managed by a caretaker coordinator. These counties have existing images and transcribers so are a great opportunity for someone to step into the role as a County Coordinator for the first time.

You will be supported by the wider FreeREG and Free UK Genealogy volunteer community, including our training volunteers, existing FreeREG coordinators and the project leadership team.

This is an excellent opportunity for someone already familiar with FreeREG who would like to take a more active role in supporting the project and helping preserve accessible family history records for future generations.

How Coordinators help FreeREG

FreeREG relies entirely on volunteers to create and maintain high-quality transcriptions of historic parish and register records. County Coordinators are central to making that work possible.

By supporting transcribers and helping organise the flow of records and images, you will help ensure that valuable historical information becomes freely available online for researchers, historians, and families around the world.

The role also helps maintain the accuracy and consistency of our records. Your support and oversight will help volunteers feel confident and connected, improving both volunteer retention and the quality of published transcriptions. County Coordinators also help strengthen relationships with archives and photographers, making it possible for FreeREG to continue expanding the range of records available to the public.

Every new set of records published can help someone uncover a family connection, understand their local history, or break through a long-standing research problem. Your contribution will directly support that work and help preserve historical information that might otherwise remain difficult to access.

As Free UK Genealogy continues developing its projects and volunteer community, County Coordinators play an essential role in sustaining and growing FreeREG for the future.

What qualities and experience are required for the role?

We are looking for someone who is organised, approachable, and comfortable supporting other volunteers.

You should have:

- An interest in family history and experience as a FreeREG/Free UK Genealogy transcriber
- Familiarity with parish registers, bishops' transcripts, or nonconformist records
- An appreciation for the scholarly nature of FreeREG's work and understanding of the importance of producing, accurate, and authoritative transcriptions. We place greater importance on quality and reliability than on volume.
- Good computer skills, particularly using internet browsers and spreadsheets
- Confidence communicating by email and through online meetings
- Good organisational skills and attention to detail
- The ability to respond to enquiries in a timely and supportive way

It would be beneficial if you have the ability to attend Google Meet video calls using a computer with a camera and microphone.

To find out more and apply, please email
dale.braden@freeukgenealogy.org.uk

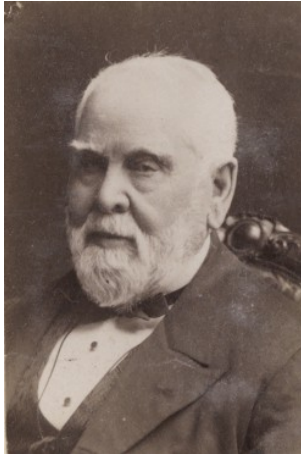
From Tasmania to Huntingdonshire

(From Sheila Padden)

The 1861 census for St Marys Parish Huntingdon (HUNRG9_975) records the names of pupils at Cowpers House School. Amongst the sons of local farmers were 3 brothers, born in Hobart Town, Tasmania. They were Henry Sultzer, James and Charles Edward and they had been sent to England to be educated by their father James Barnard. James senior, born in 1809, was the son of George Barnard, a printer of Blackfriars and Freeman of the City of London.

	George Barnard	Do	Mr	15	v	Do	Do Ramsey
	Henry Barnard	Do	Mr	14	v	Do	Tasmania Hobart Town
	Robert Freeman	Do	Mr	15	v	Do	Northamptonshire Southwick
Cowpers House School	William Jones	Pupil	Mr	14	v	Scholar	Stoke Newington
	Samuel Frank	Do		14	v	Do	Do St Ives
	James Edward Haddington	Do		14	v	Do	Stoke Newington
	William Sutton	Do		13	v	Do	Stoke Newington
	Alfred Miles	Do		13	v	Do	Do Somerset
	James Barnard	Do		13	v	Do	Tasmania (Hobart Town)
	William Barry Rose	Do		13	v	Do	Stoke Newington
	Charles Garrett	Do		13	v	Do	Stoke Newington
	George William Lovell	Do		13	v	Do	Do Do
	Thomas Nelson Reynolds	Do		12	v	Do	Stoke Newington
	George Fanny	Do		12	v	Do	Stoke Newington
	Anthony Scott Hill	Do		12	v	Do	Do Harbours
	John Thompson	Do		12	v	Do	Do Albury
	Thos William Fawke Thos	Do		12	v	Do	Stoke Newington
	William Ward	Do		11	v	Do	Stoke Newington
	Fredrick Rowell	Do		11	v	Do	Stoke Newington
	Charles Barnard	Do		11	v	Do	Tasmania Hobart Town

After serving his apprenticeship with his father James was appointed in 1838 to be the first Government printer in Van Diemens Land, used as a British penal colony before it became Tasmania. He arrived with his wife Charlotte Fox of Burton Overy in Leicestershire on the ship Pyramus in 1839.



(Photo of James Barnard – taken around 1894)

He produced many statistical papers, as well as papers on the Tasmanian Aboriginals, sugar production and paper manufacturing. He was a member of the Royal Society of Tasmania and actively supported a public library and museum, and the Botanical Gardens.

His eldest son Henry died in 1887 aged 41. His middle son James became Collector of Customs.

Third son Charles (Dr) became a renowned botanist specializing in fossil plants. Dr Charles graduated from University College in London in 1873 (listed on the medical register of 1871). He also had medical qualifications from the University of Aberdeen

For more information on James Barnard refer to the [Australian Dictionary of Biography](#) website.

Pieces Incorporated during August 2026

(Incorporated pieces are those that have been transcribed, proofread, and are now part of the online searchable database)

County	Year	Piece	Location	Civil Parishes	Number of Entries
Anglesey	1861	RG9_4346A	Beaumaris	Beaumaris, Llanddona, Llanfaes, Llanfihangel Tyn Sylwy, Llangoed, Llaniestyn, Penmon, Puffin Island MISSING	3,812
Bedfordshire	1891	RG12_1108A	Hitchin	Holwell	281
Brecknockshire	1861	RG9_4211	Brecknock	Aberysgir, Battle, Brecon St Davids (Lower Division; Upper Division), Brecon St Johns (Vennyvach), Cantref (Nantddu), Llandyfaelog Fach, Llanspyddid (Modrydd; Penpont), Llanthew	2,955
Brecknockshire	1891	RG12_4575	Llangattock	Bryn Mawr, Llangattock	5,206
Carmarthenshire	1891	RG12_4521A	Llanboidy	Cilymaenllwyd, Eglwys Fair A Churig, Llanboidy, Llanfallteg East, Llanglydwen	2,858

Denbighshire	1841	HO107_1402	Isaled	Cerrigydrudion, (Clustyblaidd; Cwmpenanner; Gwernheurn; Hafod-y-Maidd; Llaeth-wryd; Park; Voel), Gwern Howel, Gwytherin, Henllan, Llanfair Talhaearn (Barog; Bont; Botreal; Cornwall; Drebach; Melai; Pyally-Goed; Talhairn; Trebarog), Llanfihangel Glyn Myfyr (Gysulog; Llysan; Maesyr-Odyn), Llangernyw (Bodgonwch; Bodrach; Dwy-Afon; Hafodmmos; Marchalad and Branar; Nanerth; Pant-y-Manus; Pentre-Wern; Rhanhir), Llangwm (Cefn-Cymer; Disgarth; Llan; Llangwym; Llysdimel; Molfre; Nant-Haulog; Penyfoed; Rhoe-y-Mambrych), Llanefydd (Benaighn; Berron; Bodys-Gaw; Bodys-Gawen; Carredfynydd; Dinas-Gadfel; Llechryd-Ty-Celyn; Mofonog; Penfron-chill; Tal-y-bryn), Llanrhaeadr in Kinmerch (Cader; Clieudeg; Llan; Llech; Llwyn; Prior; Segwryd; Trefydd Bychain and Lewesog), Llansannan and Nantglyn (Waun; Blaunau; Gwmlwm; Hendre; Plas), Pentrefoelas (Tir-Evan or Ifan; Trebrys)	13,815
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Denbighshire	1841	HO107_1403	Isdulas	Abergele, (Bodorrn; Botegwel; Brynffanigle; Dolganned; Gurth-Gogo; Gwrych; Isaf Fowyn; Isaf Hendre-Gyda; Isaf and Uchaf Tywyn; Nant; Sirior; Uchaf Hendre-Gyda), Betws yn Rhos (Beniarth; Bodlyman; Cilcen; Dehenfryn; Maesgwig; Tai; Trellan; Trofarth), Eglwys Fach (Bodnod; Cefn-y-Coed; Esgorebrill; Pennant), Llanddoded, Llanddulas, Llandrillo yn Rhos (Cilgwyn; Colwyn; Dinerth; Llwydcoed; Mochdre; Rhiw), Llanellian (Llaithfann; Llan; Turnan), Llanfair Talhaearn (Bont; Cilie; Cynnant; Garthewin), Llanrwst (Garth-Garmon or Capel Garmon; Garthgyfanedd; Isaf Tybrith; Mathebrwyd; Tre-y-dre; Uchaf Tybrith), Llansanffraid Glan Conwy (Dennant; Llan; Trallwyn; Tre-Bwll), St George (Dinorben; Myford;	12,600
Denbighshire	1841	HO107_1406	Denbigh Borough	Denbigh	3,447
Essex	1851	HO107_1771C	Navestock	Lambourne, Navestock, Stanford Rivers, Stapleford Abbott, Stapleford Tawney, Theydon Mount	3,724
Essex	1851	HO107_1773A	Orsett	Aveley, Bulphan, Chadwell St Mary, Corringham, East Tilbury, Fobbing, Grays, Horndon on the Hill, Laindon, Mucking, North Ockendon, Orsett, South Ockendon, Stanford le Hope, Stifford, West Thurrock, West Tilbury(Tilbury Fort)	4,149

Glamorganshire	1871	RG10_5354	Whitchurch	Bedwas, (Van), Lisvane, Llanedern, Llanishen, Pentyrch, Rudry, St Martins	2,445
Glamorganshire	1871	RG10_5357	Cardiff	Cardiff St John	3,964
Glamorganshire	1871	RG10_5359	Cardiff	Cardiff St John, Cardiff St Mary	2,960
Glamorganshire	1871	RG10_5423	Margam	Margam	4,090
Glamorganshire	1871	RG10_5424	Margam	Aberavon, Margam	4,654
Glamorganshire	1891	RG12_4384	Whitchurch	Lisvane, Llanedern, Llanilltern, Llanishen, Pentyrch, Penygarn, Rudry, Van, Whitchurch	6,827
Gloucestershire	1861	RG9_1721	Bristol St James	Bristol St James In	5,318
Gloucestershire	1881	RG11_2543	Bisley	Bisley	5,271
Hampshire	1841	HO107_383B	Barton Stacey	Barton Stacey, (Bransbury; Drayton; Newton Stacey)	477
Lancashire	1861	RG9_3021	Oldham Above Town	Prestwich, (Oldham)	3,426
Lancashire	1891	RG12_3023	St Helens	Eccleston, Parr, St Helens	7,754
Lancashire	1891	RG12_3363	Burnley	Burnley	7,165

Monmouthshire	1891	RG12_4366	Usk	Goytre, Gwehelog, Gwernesney, Kemeys Commander, Llanbadog, Llangeview, Llanllowell, Llantrissant, Monkswood, Trostre, Usk	3,612
Norfolk	1841	HO107_761	South Erpingham	Alby, Aylsham, Baconsthorpe, Banningham, Barningham Parva, Belaugh, Blickling, Booton, Brampton, Burgh Next Aylsham, Burgh St Mary, Buxton, Calthorpe, Cawston, Colby, Coltishall, Corpusty, West Beckham	8,968
Northumberland	1851	HO107_2418	Morpeth	Hartburn, (Cambo; Corridge; Deanham; East Thornton with Mulldon-Park-Corner; Hartburn; Hartburn-Grange; High Angerton; Highlaws; Long Witton; Low Angerton; North Middleton; South Middleton; Todridge; Wallington Demesne; West Thornton; Whitridge), Hebburn (Causey Park; Fenrother), Longhorsley (Bigges or Carlises Quarter; Freeholders Quarter; Longshaws; Riddells Quarter; Stanton; Witton Shields), Meldon, Mitford (Benridge; Edington; High and Low Highlaws or Heighley with Highlaw Gate and Espley; Mitford; Molesden; Newton Park; Newton Underwood; Nunriding or Nunridge; Pigdon; Spittle Hill; Throphill or Thropple), Morpeth (Bullers Green; Morpeth; Morpeth Castle with Catchburn, Parkhouses and Stobhill; Newminster Abbey; Tranwell and High Church), Netherwitton (Nether Witton), River Green	7,919

Northumberland	1851	HO107_2419	Warkworth	Felton, (Acton and Old Felton; Elyhaugh; Felton; Greens and Glantlees; Swarland), Lesbury (Alnmouth; Lesbury with Bilton, Hawkhill and Wooden), Shilbottle (Guyzance or Guyson; Hazon with Heart-Law; Newton-on-the-Moor; Shilbottle; Whittle; Woodhouse), Warkworth (Acklington; Acklington Park; Amble; Birling; Brotherwick; Gloster Hill; Hauxley; High Buston; Low-Buston; Morwick or Morrick; Sturton-Grange; Togstone; Walkmill; Warkworth)	7,495
Northumberland	1851	HO107_2419A	Alnwick	Alnwick, (Abbey Lands with Broomhouse, Heckly, Heckly Farm, Heckley Grange and Whitehouse; Alnwick; Alnwick South Side with Cauledge Park, Greensfield, Grumwells Park, Hobberlaw, Rugley, Shieldykes, and Snipe House; Canongate; Denwick; Hulne Park with Hulne Abbey, Friars Buildings and Park Farm), Eglington (Bassington)	7,376
Pembrokeshire	1861	RG9_4154	Tenby	Caldy Island MISSING, Nash (Upton), Pembroke (St Michael), Penally, Redberth, St Margarets Island MISSING, Tenby (St Mary In; St Mary Out)	2,512
Pembrokeshire	1861	RG9_4156	Pembroke	Pembroke, (St Mary)	4,467
Pembrokeshire	1861	RG9_4157	Pembroke	Bosherston, Castlemartin, Pembroke (Pembroke Dock; St Mary), Rhoscrowther, St Petrox, St Twynells, Stackpole Elidor, Warren	2,265

Pembrokeshire	1891	RG12_4521	Llanboidy	Llanfallteg West, Mynachlog Ddu	488
Radnorshire	1891	RG12_2075A	Brilley	Michaelchurch on Arrow	234
Staffordshire	1891	RG12_2252	Walsall	Walsall Foreign	6,745
Worcestershire	1891	RG12_2071A	Brockhampton	Lower Sapey	205
Yorkshire West Riding	1891	RG12_3761	Pontefract	Monkhill, Pontefract, Pontefract Park, Tanshelf	5,677
Yorkshire West Riding	1891	RG12_3797	Nether Hallam	Nether Hallam	6,466

FreeCEN1

The last reported update to our old website at [FreeCEN1](#) took place on July 6th 2021. Further updates to this website have been discontinued, and any new uploads of completed pieces will take place on FreeCEN2 only.

We expect that the old website will be taken off-line at some point.